paramount.

iii. There is evidence that even modest improvements in governance can yield significant returns. Improving monitoring and supervision of schools is significantly correlated with reductions in teacher absence, and investing in improved governance by increasing the frequency of monitoring could yield an eight-to-tenfold return on investment in terms of reducing the fiscal cost of teacher absence.

iv. The importance of motivating teachers by rewarding good performance has also been pointed out by the evidences. Rigorous evaluations of carefully designed systems of teacher performance pay in Andhra Pradesh show substantial improvements in student learning in response to even very modest amounts of 'performance-linked pay' for teachers, that was typically not more than 3 per cent of annual pay.

v. Evidence from a long-term follow up shows that teacher performance pay was 15 to 20 more times more effective for raising student learning than reductions in pupil-teacher ratios.

vi. More broadly, these results suggest that the performance of front-line government employees depends less on the level of pay and more on its structure.

WAY TO POLICY

Putting the lessons taken from the evidences discussed above, following three immediate policy measures are desired at the moment for right kind of 'human resource preparedness'[46].

1. Make learning outcomes an explicit goal of primary education policy and invest in regular and independent high-quality measurement of learning outcomes. While independently measuring and administratively focusing on learning outcomes will not by itself lead to improvement, it will serve to focus the energies of the education system on the outcome that actually matters to millions of first-generation learners, which is functional literacy and numeracy.